



Force of nature: Tejaswin Shankar already has a bronze in the men's high jump from four years ago. He also owns the second-highest season's best in men's decathlon. GETTY IMAGES

17.08m placing him second in the field at Glasgow. Although his best is still some way behind Jamaican Jordan Scott's 17.69m, Praveen has said he's targeting a leap of 17.50m. Anything close to that would certainly keep him in the hunt for gold.

Also looking for a place at the top of the podium will be high jumper Sarvesh Kushare, who cleared a personal best 2.31m at last month's

Inter-State Championships. That mark is the joint highest among Commonwealth nations alongside that of England's Kimani Jack and is higher than that of reigning Olympic and world champion Hamish Kerr of New Zealand, whose season's best stands at 2.28m.

Tejaswin Shankar and Tejas Shirse will look to reach the podium in the men's decathlon and men's 110m hurdles respectively. Tejaswin

already has a bronze in the men's high jump from four years ago. He also owns the second-highest season's best in men's decathlon among the Glasgow field (8,057 points — a national record), behind only Canada's Damian Warner (8,497 points).

Considering Tejaswin achieved his score using less-than-ideal equipment — he had avoided bringing his vaulting poles to India, preferring to fly them directly to Scotland — he will be in a strong position to improve further.

Tejas, meanwhile, has a season's best of 13.27 seconds, which is not only a national record but also ranks him second this year among athletes entered for the Commonwealth Games.

Also in with a chance of a medal is Gulveer Singh, whose national record of 13:03.93 in men's 5000m places him fourth among Commonwealth Games athletes behind Australia's Ky Robinson (12:50.82), Kenya's Cornelius Kemboi (12:56.02) and Mathew Kipsang (12:58.95).

In the women's events, medals will likely be harder to come by. Well placed to make the podium is discus thrower Seema Punia (**facing page, below**), whose season's best of 59.73m places her third among likely competitors behind Jamaica's Samantha Hall (66.39m) and Canada's Julia Tunks (63.58m).

Parul Chaudhary (**left**), in the 3000m steeplechase, is also in the mix for a medal, with her season's best of 9:12.84 placing her fourth among likely competitors in Glasgow.

There's still plenty to look forward to even among Indians who aren't favourites to stand on top of the podium. Take the men's 100m sprint, for example, in which Gurindervir Singh set the national record of 10.09 seconds at the Federation Cup in Ranchi in May. Gurindervir's effort is only the 14th fastest among confirmed entrants for the Commonwealth Games. There are 10 runners who have broken the 10-second barrier. While that means it's very unlikely Gurindervir will be



GETTY IMAGES